

Pavan Kumar Nayakanti

Azure Platform Tech Lead | IaC Lifecycle & CI/CD Enablement | DevSecOps | Kubernetes | Developer Enablement
I Cloud Governance

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EXPERIENCE

Sr. Specialist - Cloud Practice & SRE

IRIS Software - India (Clients: ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO)

Sep 2020 - Present Hyderabad, India

- Productized IaC Platform (CPMI Framework):** Designed and delivered the Cloud Platform Maturity Index (CPMI) - a productized IaC framework of reusable Terraform and AWS CDK modules, governance guardrails, naming conventions, and tagging policies deployed as a shared platform capability across ADP, Charles Schwab, and BMO. Built the paved road for multiple product teams to provision infrastructure consistently and securely.
- CI/CD Pipeline Leadership (modeas):** Engineered cloud-native CI/CD platform (modeas) with validation, approval, and promotion gates - handling 200+ builds/deployments per hour using Kubernetes, Docker, and Helm; embedded pipelines into the development lifecycle across multiple product teams, eliminating 10,000+ manual operational hours annually.
- Azure Cloud Platform Engineering (BMO):** Authored Terraform and AWS CDK infrastructure-as-code for landing zones on ECS Fargate, Lambda serverless, and AKS-equivalent container workloads; automated certificate management, Key Vault configurations, storage accounts, backup policies, and health monitoring - HA/DR compliance-by-design from day one.
- Observability Enablement (ADP):** Deployed platform-level observability toolchain - Prometheus, Grafana, Dynatrace, and Splunk - as shared monitoring infrastructure; defined SLI/SLO patterns and alert templates reusable by product teams; reduced MTTR by 40%+ via Python and Ansible automated remediation.
- Chaos Engineering & Non-Functional Ownership:** Implemented Keptn-based chaos engineering for resilience testing and proactive fault injection; owned production readiness including non-functional requirements (reliability, security, scalability) before service acceptance into operations.
- Technical Mentoring & Engineering Culture:** IRIS Certified Trainer (Q2 and Q3 2024); delivered quarterly training sessions for up to 200 engineers on SRE, DevOps, and cloud platform engineering; mentored engineers on IaC best practices, code review standards, and DevSecOps adoption.

SUMMARY

20+ year Azure platform engineering specialist with deep hands-on expertise in IaC lifecycle ownership (Terraform, AWS CDK), CI/CD pipeline design with approval/promotion gates (Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions), and DevSecOps toolchain integration (SonarQube, JFrog, SAST/DAST/IAST). Built productized IaC frameworks and reusable CI/CD templates as shared platform capabilities for multiple product teams at enterprise scale. Strong track record translating HLD to LLD, mentoring engineers on platform best practices, and driving governance-by-design (SOX, GDPR, compliance guardrails) across regulated financial services environments. Certified AZ-305, CKAD, AWS SAA-C01, GCP PCA.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- CPMI: Paved Road at Scale**
Productized IaC framework (Terraform/CDK modules + governance guardrails) deployed as shared platform capability across ADP, Schwab, and BMO.
- 98% Onboarding Reduction**
CI/CD platform with SOX-compliant approval gates cut app onboarding from 5 weeks to 5 hours across 250+ RBC applications.
- modeas: 200+ Builds/Hour**
Cloud-native CI/CD platform with validation/promotion gates eliminated 10,000+ manual ops hours/year; 600% deployment cadence improvement.
- MTTR -40% via Observability**
Platform-level Prometheus + Dynatrace + Splunk observability with Ansible auto-remediation at ADP SRE.

Automation Technology Specialist

IRIS Software - Toronto, Canada (Client: Royal Bank of Canada)

 Jun 2018 - Sep 2020  Toronto, Canada

- **CI/CD Platform with Governance Gates (Robo Deployment Framework):** Designed and owned a PowerShell and Python-native CI/CD orchestration platform with plan/validate/approval/apply gates - SOX-compliant, audit-ready change pipelines for .NET/C# services, Windows services, and database workloads; reduced application onboarding from 5 weeks to 5 hours (98% reduction) across 250+ applications.
- **DevSecOps Pipeline Integration:** Embedded SAST, DAST, and IAST scanning (SonarQube, JFrog Artifactory) as standard pipeline stages; implemented secrets management, OAuth2/OIDC token policies, and SOX/GDPR compliance guardrails - shift-left security as a platform-level default across 250+ app workloads at RBC.
- **Azure DevOps & Git Workflow Governance:** Implemented DORA metrics (Deployment Frequency, MTTR, Change Failure Rate, Lead Time) via Azure DevOps; established branching strategies, PR approval workflows, and pipeline-based validation gates - measurable improvement in delivery performance and production stability across RBC Wealth Management and Insurance.
- Automated migration of 250+ applications across 60+ teams from CA SCM/Harvest to GitHub Enterprise; enabled self-service CI/CD, modern branching workflows, and agile collaboration at scale.

Automation Architect

IRIS Software - Toronto, Canada (Insurance & Capital Markets)

 Feb 2017 - Jun 2018  Toronto, Canada

- Designed and owned container-orchestrated deployment pipelines (Kubernetes, Helm) for zero-downtime rollouts; delivered automation across 80+ applications on heterogeneous stacks (Java, NodeJS, Kafka, Salesforce, Mainframe) using Python and Bash scripting frameworks.
- Translated HLD designs into LLD implementations for enterprise automation platforms; coordinated cross-team dependencies and integration points across capital markets and insurance domains.

Technology Manager - Infrastructure & Platform

TechMahindra Pvt. Ltd. - India (Client: Adobe)

 Jul 2015 - Feb 2017  Noida, India

- Owned end-to-end LLD and execution of zero-downtime data centre migration for Adobe - full production cutover with no service disruption; led SAP HANA upgrades and Informatica-to-SQL Server ETL re-engineering at enterprise scale.

Sr. SDET - Production Engineering

Microsoft Corporation - India

 Jul 2007 - Dec 2014  Hyderabad, India

- Owned production operations and quality engineering for global Sales & Marketing platforms (US, EMEA, APAC): incident response, RCA, infrastructure administration, and 99.99% uptime sustained over 7 years. Built CI/CD-integrated test automation and led cloud migration with self-healing architectures supporting 200% user growth.

CERTIFICATIONS

Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305)

Microsoft - 2026

Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD)

CNCF - 2025

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate

Amazon Web Services - 2026

Professional Cloud Architect (GCP)

Google Cloud - 2026

AI-102: Azure AI Solution Design

Microsoft - 2025

Certified SRE (iSRE)

iSRE Institute

EDUCATION

Masters in Artificial Intelligence 2024

Woolf University

General Management Program 2022

ISB Hyderabad

M.Sc in Computer Science 2002

Osmania University